coursera | MoMA

What Is Contemporary Art?

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Module 4
Materials & Making

Module 5
Agency

Visibility

- ✓ Introduction to Module 5
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Pope.L's New York crawls
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ In New York City with Pope.L | Direct action
  Video • 4 min
- ✓ Two artists consider Catherine Opie, Dyke, 1993
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Tania Bruguera on Untitled (Havana, 2000), 2000
  Video • 4 min
- ✓ Luis Camnitzer on Memorial, 2009
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Yara Said on the Refugee Flag, 2016
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Firelei Báez on For Améthyste and Athénaïre (Exiled Muses Beyond Jean Luc Nancy's Canon), Anacaonas, 2018
  Reading • 10 min

Voice

- ✓ Who speaks?
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Nick Cave on Soundsuit, 2011
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Lawrence Abu Hamdan, Conflicted Phonemes, 2012
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ P Staff on Weed Killer, 2017
  Reading • 10 min

Action

- ✓ Taking action
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Lorraine O'Grady on Mlle Bourgeoise Noire, 1980–83/2009
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Xiao Lu on Dialogue, 1989
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Ralph Borland, Suited for Subversion (Prototype), 2002
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Defining and blurring identities through performance
  Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond

- ✓ Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%
- ✓ Reflect on Agency in Module 5
  Dialogue • 15 min
- ✓ Optional Readings & Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Power

Exposing Power

- ✓ Introduction to Module 6
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Instructor Christian Rattemeyer on Mark Lombardi's diagrams of power
  Video • 6 min
- ✓ What do war and peace have to do with chandeliers and portraits?
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Deana Lawson on Nation, 2017
  Video • 2 min

Abuse of Power

- ○ **How do artists critique power?**
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Two responses to abuse of power
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Wolfgang Tillmans on Sendeschluss / End of Broadcast I, 2014
  Video • 2 min

Sources of Power

- ○ Power: sources and resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Outer space to inner earth
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Curator Paola Antonelli on Massoud Hassani's Mine Kafon wind-powered deminer, 2011
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Rania Ghosn on After Oil, 2016
  Video • 4 min

Review & Respond

- ○ Memory Check
  Practice Assignment
- ○ Reflecting on Power in Art
  Dialogue • 15 min
- ○ Final course reflection
  Graded Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Readings & Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ End-of-course survey
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Recordings of live virtual sessions (optional)
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ MoMA Resources
  Reading • 10 min

How do artists critique power?

0:05 / 0:39 1x

With power comes responsibility and, as we have seen repeated throughout time, so does its abuse. The two artists and one collective you'll meet next address this head-on.

We start with Jenny Holzer, who cuts to the point with a bracing statement offering one particular take on power. From Holzer we move to a multichannel video orchestrated by a Russian collective that calls itself Chto Delat, meaning What is to be done? In this case, they ask themselves what is to be done about their powerlessness in the face of increasing authoritarian aggression. Finally, we'll hear from Wolfgang Tillmans about his subtle critique of state power.

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